

Course and Module Structuring Principles in Curriculum Design for CBET

1 Introduction to CBET Curriculum Structuring

Competency-Based Education and Training (CBET) focuses on developing learners' ability to demonstrate specific competencies required in the workplace. Therefore, course and module structuring in CBET must be:

- Industry-driven
- Outcome-oriented
- Learner-centered
- Flexible and modular
- Assessment-aligned

Structuring ensures that learning progresses logically from foundational to advanced competencies while maintaining relevance to occupational standards.

2 Principles of Course Structuring in CBET

A course in CBET refers to the entire qualification or program designed to prepare learners for a specific occupation or role.

2.1 Alignment with Occupational Standards

- Courses must be derived directly from occupational standards.
- Each course outcome should reflect industry-required competencies.
- Learning outcomes must match performance criteria specified in the standards.

Key Principle:

Start with workplace expectations, then design backward.

2.2 Outcome-Based Design

- Define clear learning outcomes for the course.
- Outcomes must be:
 - Measurable
 - Observable
 - Competency-focused
- Use action verbs (e.g., demonstrate, install, analyze, troubleshoot).

This aligns with Outcome-Based Education (OBE) principles.

2.3 Modularization

CBET courses are broken into modules, each representing a cluster of related competencies.

Benefits:

- Flexibility in delivery
- Easier assessment
- Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL)
- Incremental certification

Each module should:

- Focus on a complete and meaningful task
- Be independently assessable
- Contribute to overall qualification

2.4 Logical Sequencing

Competencies should be structured from:

1. Foundational → Intermediate → Advanced
2. Simple → Complex
3. Theory → Practice
4. Supervised → Independent performance

Sequencing ensures progressive mastery.

2.5 Integration of Theory and Practice

- Theory must directly support practical application.
- Avoid separating knowledge from skills.
- Learning activities should simulate real workplace situations.

Principle:

Learn by doing.

2.6 Flexibility and Accessibility

CBET courses should allow:

- Self-paced learning
- Flexible entry and exit
- Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL)
- Workplace-based training options

3 Principles of Module Structuring in CBET

A module is a self-contained unit of learning focused on a specific competency or group of competencies.

3.1 Clear Competency Focus

Each module must:

- Address a specific competency or unit of competency
- Be based on clearly defined elements and performance criteria
- Specify required knowledge, skills, and attitudes

3.2 Competency-Based Learning Outcomes

Module outcomes must:

- Be observable and measurable
- Reflect workplace tasks
- Align with performance standards

Example Format:

“By the end of this module, the learner will be able to install and test electrical wiring systems according to safety regulations.”

3.3 Structured Components of a Module

A well-designed CBET module typically includes:

1. Module Title
2. Competency Unit Reference
3. Learning Outcomes
4. Content Outline

5. Learning Activities
6. Resources Required
7. Assessment Criteria
8. Assessment Methods

3.4 Integrated Assessment Strategy

Assessment in CBET modules must:

- Be criterion-referenced
- Measure performance against set standards
- Include practical demonstration
- Use workplace simulations or real tasks

Assessment methods may include:

- Direct observation
- Practical tasks
- Projects
- Oral questioning
- Portfolio evidence

3.5 Mastery Learning Principle

- Learners must demonstrate competence before progressing.
- No grading based on comparison with peers.
- Competence is either “Achieved” or “Not Yet Achieved.”

3.6 Time Flexibility

In CBET:

- Time is flexible.
- Competence is fixed.
- Learners progress when ready.

4 Horizontal and Vertical Integration

4.1 Horizontal Integration

- Linking related competencies within the same level
- Promotes interdisciplinary understanding

4.2 Vertical Integration

- Building competencies progressively across levels
- Ensures skill advancement and specialization

5 Industry Relevance and Stakeholder Involvement

Course and module structuring must involve:

- Employers
- Industry experts
- Regulatory bodies
- Professional associations

This ensures:

- Relevance

- Employability
- Currency of competencies

6 Learning Resources Alignment

Resources must reflect real workplace conditions:

- Equipment
- Tools
- Materials
- Industry-standard procedures
- Safety regulations

Authenticity enhances competency development.

7 Documentation and Standardization

Each module should clearly document:

- Performance criteria
- Evidence requirements
- Conditions of assessment
- Range statements

This ensures consistency across trainers and institutions.

8 Key Structuring Model in CBET

A simple structuring flow:

1. Occupational Standards
2. Units of Competency
3. Elements of Competency
4. Performance Criteria
5. Module Design
6. Learning Activities
7. Assessment Strategy

9 Summary of Core Principles

Effective course and module structuring in CBET must be:

- Competency-driven
- Industry-aligned
- Modular and flexible
- Outcome-based
- Assessment-centered
- Practice-oriented
- Mastery-focused

10 Conclusion

In CBET, curriculum structuring begins with the workplace and works backward to learning. Courses are organized into modular, competency-based units that ensure learners demonstrate real, measurable skills aligned with occupational standards. Proper structuring guarantees relevance, flexibility, and mastery of competencies required for employment.